ONDJ 2026/27 rainfall outlook

ECMWF SEAS5 initialized 1 September 2026 · calibrated with CHIRPS v2.0 · ONDJ R3 (Deyr) rainfall domain

Research reconstruction — not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

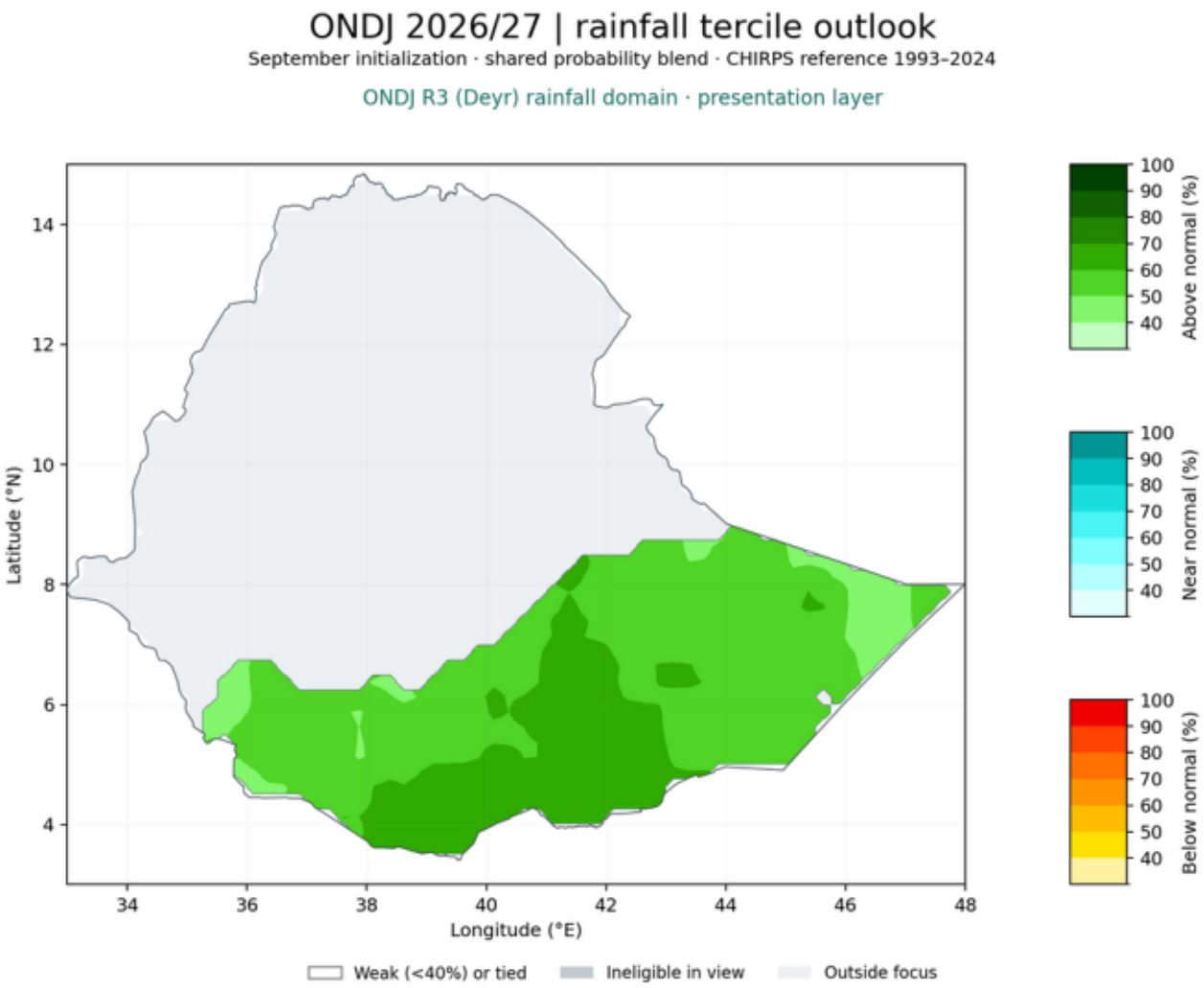
The forecast leans toward above normal rainfall in the ONDJ R3 (Deyr) rainfall domain: averaged over the area, the local probability of above normal is 57%, against about 33% for climatology. Mean forecast rainfall is 240 mm against a 1993/94–2024/25 average of 176 mm (+64 mm, +37%).

Below normal 19% **Near normal 24%** **Above normal 57%**

Average local probability: each grid cell has its own tercile probabilities; these are their averages over the 100% of the area that has probabilities, not the probability that the area-total rainfall falls in a category.

Forecast signal: Strong tilt toward above normal (largest area-average probability compared with a one-third reference; based on probabilities only).

Historical skill (ONDJ R3 (Deyr) rainfall domain): Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero). Probability skill (RPSS) +0.093, cross-validated 1993–2016, 95% interval +0.012 to +0.182; better than climatology in 18 of 24 years. A strong signal is not a confidence rating.



Display interpolation: 12×; Gaussian σ=0.6 native cells. Statistics and exported fields use the original 0.25° grid.
Research reconstruction of a September-initialized forecast; not an official EMI/ICPAC product.

All targets, evidence and record

ONDJ 2026/27 — September initialization · ONDJ R3 (Deyr) rainfall domain

Target	Below/near/above	Coverage	Anomaly	Verification status
ONDJ 2026/27	19% / 24% / 57%	100%	+64 mm	Target period ongoing (ends 31 Jan 2027)
Oct 2026	27% / 30% / 43%	100%	+20 mm	Target period ongoing (ends 31 Oct 2026)
Nov 2026	21% / 22% / 57%	100%	+31 mm	Target period starts 1 Nov 2026
Dec 2026	32% / 31% / 37%	54%	+4 mm	Target period starts 1 Dec 2026
Jan 2027	29% / 37% / 34%	43%	+2 mm	Target period starts 1 Jan 2027

Historical skill, cross-validated (probability skill, RPSS, with whole-year 95% interval)

Target	RPSS (95% interval)	Yrs better	Holm p	In words
ONDJ	+0.093 (+0.012 to +0.182)	18/24	0.104	Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero)
Oct	+0.055 (−0.001 to +0.109)	19/24	0.134	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Nov	+0.091 (−0.020 to +0.201)	16/24	0.181	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Dec	+0.024 (−0.026 to +0.079)	12/24	0.417	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Jan	+0.007 (−0.011 to +0.025)	15/24	0.417	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain

Verification against CHIRPS (single season or month)

No target has been verified yet.

Cycle record

Model initialization: 1 September 2026 · ECMWF SEAS5 (system 51), 51 members

Target period: 1 Oct 2026 – 31 Jan 2027

Forecast record: Generated 7 Oct 2026; not yet frozen for verification (freeze before observations are used)

Publication status: Research reconstruction: produced after the initialization date with the published method; not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

Reference period: CHIRPS v2.0 ONDJ 1993/94–2024/25 (32 seasons)

Observations processed through: None yet

CHIRPS archive: Official CHIRPS v2.0 p25 by_month listing checked 10 Oct 2026: monthly files through Aug 2026; Feb 2026 file not found

Verification last run: Not run

Method / version: Shared climatology blend (λ = 0.28 for ONDJ) · code 39e6509

How to read: terciles split the reference-period rainfall into three equally likely parts. Climatology assigns about one-third to each (the observed tercile frequencies of the training years). Skill scores are decimals: +0.05 means a 5% lower score than climatology. RPSS refers to the blended probabilities; CRPSS and bias to the amount-corrected ensemble.

Limitations: few evaluation years and single verification seasons give wide uncertainty; the 0.25° maps repeat ~1° model information; the rainfall domain is for display and summaries only.

Monthly tercile outlooks

ONDJ 2026/27 — September initialization · ONDJ R3 (Deyr) rainfall domain

